

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent
Kind Code
Date of Patent
Inventor(s)

12406095
B2
September 02, 2025
Schenkein; Scott

Methods and systems for adapting an application programming interface

Abstract

A computer-implemented method for adapting an application programming interface (API), according to some embodiments, includes: determining that a data field of API response data satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation to data stored in the data field; and modifying the API response data by performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field. A computer-implemented method for adapting an application programming interface (API), according to some embodiments, includes: determining that a data field of an API call satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation to data stored in the data field; and performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field of the API call.

Inventors: Schenkein; Scott (Midlothian, VA)
Applicant: Capital One Services, LLC (McLean, VA)
Family ID: 70774992
Assignee: Capital One Services, LLC (McLean, VA)
Appl. No.: 18/661842
Filed: May 13, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240296247 A1	Sep. 05, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17732650 20220429 US 12013967 child-doc US 18661842
continuation parent-doc US 16855512 20200422 US 11321483 20220503 child-doc US 17732650
continuation parent-doc US 16419844 20190522 US 10664615 20200526 child-doc US 16855512

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **H04L9/40** (20220101); **G06F21/62** (20130101); **H04L67/01** (20220101); **H04L67/02** (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06F21/6281** (20130101); **G06F21/6245** (20130101); **H04L63/0281** (20130101); **H04L63/0442** (20130101); **H04L67/01** (20220501); **H04L67/02** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (21/6281); G06F (21/6245); H04L (67/01); H04L (63/0281); H04L (63/0442); H04L (67/02)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7783613	12/2009	Gupta et al.	N/A	N/A
8255479	12/2011	Killmer	N/A	N/A
8276186	12/2011	DeFord et al.	N/A	N/A
9021135	12/2014	Ang et al.	N/A	N/A
9241004	12/2015	April	N/A	N/A
9294594	12/2015	Koo	N/A	N/A
9898610	12/2017	Hadsall	N/A	N/A
9935460	12/2017	Tupper	N/A	H02J 3/008
10148493	12/2017	Ennis, Jr. et al.	N/A	N/A
10194001	12/2018	Gardiner et al.	N/A	N/A
10216449	12/2018	Li et al.	N/A	N/A
10528937	12/2019	Murali	N/A	G06Q 20/22
10715315	12/2019	Proctor	N/A	H04L 9/3213
10769000	12/2019	Plunk et al.	N/A	N/A
10824588	12/2019	Ramamurthy et al.	N/A	N/A
2002/0099952	12/2001	Lambert et al.	N/A	N/A
2003/0031165	12/2002	O'Brien, Jr.	N/A	N/A
2004/0003412	12/2003	Halbert	N/A	N/A
2004/0064351	12/2003	Mikurak	N/A	N/A
2004/0088250	12/2003	Bartter et al.	N/A	N/A
2005/0228984	12/2004	Edery et al.	N/A	N/A
2006/0059421	12/2005	Benbrahim	715/234	G06F 16/258
2007/0050871	12/2006	Mashhour	N/A	N/A
2007/0229905	12/2006	Furukawa	358/1.18	B41C 1/00
2008/0256205	12/2007	Mahoney	N/A	N/A
2010/0290600	12/2009	Agranovsky et al.	N/A	N/A
2011/0307710	12/2010	McGuire et al.	N/A	N/A
2014/0032219	12/2013	Lerner et al.	N/A	N/A
2014/0115710	12/2013	Hughes et al.	N/A	N/A
2015/0215305	12/2014	Wetzel et al.	N/A	N/A

2015/0347740	12/2014	O'Malley	726/4	G07C 9/37
2016/0014076	12/2015	Hansen	N/A	N/A
2016/0088023	12/2015	Handa et al.	N/A	N/A
2016/0321218	12/2015	Farncombe	N/A	G06F 40/143
2016/0335451	12/2015	Sinor	N/A	N/A
2017/0118268	12/2016	Wu	N/A	H04L 67/10
2017/0126677	12/2016	Kumar et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0169212	12/2016	Bello et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0214521	12/2016	Busch	N/A	H04L 9/0618
2017/0220798	12/2016	Madou et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0152418	12/2017	Tableman	N/A	N/A
2018/0278471	12/2017	Burli et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0365140	12/2017	Bates	N/A	N/A
2019/0036678	12/2018	Ahmed	N/A	N/A
2019/0050380	12/2018	Wetzel et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0081982	12/2018	Breton et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0114417	12/2018	Subbarayan et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0207754	12/2018	Iyer	N/A	H04L 9/0877
2019/0386984	12/2018	Thakkar	N/A	H04L 63/18
2020/0150904	12/2019	Maurya et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0202874	12/2019	Kuznetsov	N/A	G10L 19/018
2020/0236187	12/2019	Tal et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0337009	12/2020	Spång	N/A	H04L 67/564
2022/0038439	12/2021	Aceto	N/A	G06Q 20/4014
2022/0150692	12/2021	O'Kane	N/A	H04L 67/125

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2017161403	12/2016	WO	N/A

Primary Examiner: Jamshidi; Ghodrat

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Bookoff McAndrews, PLLC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This patent application is a continuation of and claims the benefit of priority to U.S. Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 17/732,650, filed Apr. 29, 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 16/855,512, filed Apr. 22, 2020, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,321,483, which is a continuation of U.S. Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 16/419,844, filed May 22, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,664,615, the entirety of each of which being incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Various embodiments of the present disclosure relate generally to controlling inputs and outputs of an application programming interface (API), and relate particularly to methods and systems for adapting APIs.

BACKGROUND

(2) An application programming interface (API) is often designed based on certain security assumptions. However, security assumptions may change over time. For example, an API designed

for usage within a private network may later be deployed to provide services to public clients, or new compliance requirements governing data input or output by the API may arise. In such scenarios, rewriting the existing API to accommodate new security or compliance requirements may be costly and may cause disruption of existing usage of the API. Additionally, building field-level security considerations into applications in a non-centralized manner may lead to inconsistent solutions with difficult-to-assess levels of security. Additionally, field-level security tends to require specialized security skills that might not be readily available.

(3) The background description provided herein is for the purpose of generally presenting the context of the disclosure. Unless otherwise indicated herein, the materials described in this section are not prior art to the claims in this application and are not admitted to be prior art, or suggestions of the prior art, by inclusion in this section.

SUMMARY

(4) According to certain aspects of the disclosure methods, systems, and non-transitory computer-readable media are disclosed for adapting application programming interfaces. Each of the examples disclosed herein may include one or more of the features described in connection with any of the other disclosed examples.

(5) In one example, a computer-implemented method for adapting an application programming interface (API) may include receiving, from a client computer system, an API call for requesting information from a server. The method may further include calling an API of the server to request the information, and receiving, from the server, API response data including a data field storing data. Additionally, the method may include determining that the data field of the API response data satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation to the data stored in the data field, modifying the API response data by performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field, and sending, to the client computer system, the modified API response data.

(6) In another example, a computer-implemented method for adapting an application programming interface (API) may include receiving, from a client computer system, an API call requesting information from a server, and determining that a data field of the API call satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation to data stored in the data field. Additionally, the method may include performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field of the API call to obtain processed data, and based on the API call, generating a second API call for requesting the information stored on the server, the second API call including the processed data. Further, the method may include sending the second API call to the server, retrieving, from the server, API response data generated by the server in response to the second API call, and sending, to the client computer system, the API response data or a modification of the API response data.

(7) In another example, a computer system for adapting an application programming interface (API) may include a memory storing instructions and configuration data specifying a data field identifier and a data security operation to be applied to data in a data field having the data field identifier. Additionally, the system may include one or more processors configured to execute the instructions to perform operations. The operations may include receiving, from a client computer system, an API call requesting information from a server, calling an API of the server to request the information, receiving, from the server, API response data including an API response data field storing data, determining that the API response data field has an identifier matching the data field identifier specified in the configuration data, modifying the API response data by performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field, and sending, to the client computer system, the modified API response data.

(8) Additional objects and advantages of the disclosed embodiments will be set forth in part in the description that follows, and in part will be apparent from the description, or may be learned by practice of the disclosed embodiments.

(9) It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed

description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive of the disclosed embodiments, as claimed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate various exemplary embodiments and together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the disclosed embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 1A depicts a client-server environment, according to one or more embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 1B depicts an example of data flow in a portion of the client-server environment of FIG. 1A, according to one or more embodiments.
- (4) FIGS. 2A and 2B depict example topologies for the client-server environment of FIG. 1A, according to one or more embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 3 illustrates a process for adapting an API by rewriting an output of the API, according to one or more embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 4 illustrates a process for adapting an API by rewriting an input of the API, according to one or more embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 5 illustrates an example of a process in which decryption is performed on information received from a client computer system, according to one or more embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

- (8) The terminology used in this disclosure is to be interpreted in its broadest reasonable manner, even though it is being used in conjunction with a detailed description of certain specific examples of the present disclosure. Indeed, certain terms may even be emphasized below; however, any terminology intended to be interpreted in any restricted manner will be overtly and specifically defined as such in this Detailed Description section. Both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive of the features, as claimed.
- (9) In this disclosure, the term “computer system” generally encompasses any device or combination of devices, each device having at least one processor that executes instructions from a memory medium. Additionally, a computer system may be included as a part of another computer system.
- (10) In this disclosure, the term “based on” means “based at least in part on.” The singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural referents unless the context dictates otherwise. The term “exemplary” is used in the sense of “example” rather than “ideal.” The term “or” is meant to be inclusive and means either, any, several, or all of the listed items. The terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” “including,” or other variations thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion such that a process, method, or product that comprises a list of elements does not necessarily include only those elements, but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such a process, method, article, or apparatus. Relative terms, such as, “substantially” and “generally,” are used to indicate a possible variation of $\pm 10\%$ of a stated or understood value.
- (11) In general, the present disclosure provides methods and systems for adapting an existing application programming interface (API). As will be discussed below in more detail, in methods and systems according to the present disclosure, the existing API may be adapted by using an API service adapter that rewrites the input and outputs of the existing API. The API service adapter therefore provides a “bolt-on” adapter that can adapt the existing API to various security formats and security requirements for the input and output of the API.
- (12) FIG. 1A illustrates a client-server environment **100** according to the present disclosure. The environment **100** may include a client **110**, an API service adapter **120**, and a server **132**. The server

132 may provide a service through an API **130** of the server **132**. This service provided through API **130** also may be referred to as an API service.

(13) The server **132** may, for example, be a computer system or be implemented by a computer system. As mentioned above, the server **132** may offer a service through the API **130**. For example, the server **132** may provide data or information in response to a request received by the server **132** through the API **130**. Such requests may be referred to as API calls or API requests. The data or information provided by the server **132** may be stored in a memory, database, or other data storage that is part of the server **132**, and may be retrieved by the server **132** in response to the request. However, it is also possible for the data or information provided by the server **132**, or portions thereof, to be stored at a location external to the server, in which case the server **132** may first retrieve the data or information from another source before providing the data or information to the requesting party. The API **130** may, for example, be a REST or SOAP API, and return information in JSON or XML format. In some embodiments, the server **132** may be a web server or an application server.

(14) The client **110** may, for example, be a computer system, which may be referred to as a client computer system or a client system. Referring to FIG. 1A, in order for the client **110** to access the service provided by the server **132**, the client **110** may send an API call **142**, which may be received by the API service adapter **120**. The API service adapter **120**, in response to receiving request **142**, may send an API call **144** to the API **130**. Depending on the particular implementation or circumstances, the payload of the API call **144** (e.g., data of interest contained within the API call **144**) may be the same (e.g., identical) as the payload of the API call **142** (e.g., data of interest contained within the API call **142**). For example, the API call **144** may be the same as the API call **142** except for the address to which the call is directed. Instead of passing the payload through, the API service adapter **120** may instead modify the payload of API call **142** to generate the API call **144** that is subsequently submitted to, and received by, the API **130**. In such a situation, the API call **144** may be referred to as a modified (or rewritten) API call. The modification of the payload of the API call **142** also may be referred to as the rewriting of the input of the API **130**.

(15) API calls **142** and **144** may request certain information, in which case the API calls **142** and **144** may be referred to as API calls for requesting information. This information may be any information provided by the API **130** of the server **132**. The information may, for example, be sensitive information. In general, sensitive information may include account numbers, such as a primary account number (PAN), credit card number, and/or a deposited account ID. Sensitive information also may include personal identifiers, such as an ID number, a social security number, or a social insurance number. Other examples of information that may be requested from the server **132** include credit card or account balances, account transactions, etc.

(16) The API calls **142** and **144** may likewise include sensitive information or other information. For example, in order to request an account balance from the API **130**, the API call **144** may need to supply a primary account number, which may be sensitive information. As another example, the API call **142** may include information to be used by the API service adapter **120**, such as for encryption or decryption.

(17) The server **132**, in response to receiving the API call **144** through API **130**, may generate and return API response data **152** to the API service adapter **120** through the API **130**. It is noted that the term “API response data” is used to broadly refer to any data returned by the server **132** through the API **130**. The API service adapter **120**, in response to receiving the API response data **152**, may transmit API response data **154** to the client **110**. Depending on the particular implementation or circumstances, the API service adapter **120** may modify the payload of the API response data **152** returned by the API **130** to generate the API response data **154**, in which case API response data **154** may be referred to as a modified (or rewritten) API response data. In this case, the modification of the API response data **152** is the data received by the client **110**. Alternatively, the API response data **152** may pass through the API service adapter **120** as API response data **154** without

modification to its payload.

(18) The modification of the payload API response data **152** may be referred to as the rewriting of the output of the API **130**. In various implementations, either the output or input of the API **130**, or both or neither, may be modified. Such modification may include the application of a data security operation, discussed below in more detail.

(19) The API service adapter **120** may be implemented by a gateway or a proxy included in the gateway. The API service adapter **120** may operate as a filter that modifies the contents (e.g., payloads) of the API response data **152** by applying one or more security operations to a field included in the API response data **152**. Thus, the API service adapter **120** also may be referred to as a filtering API.

(20) A security operation may be an operation that increases the security level of processed data, or an operation that decreases the security level of processed data. Examples of operations that increase the security level include tokenization, field masking, field redaction (e.g., removal of the field), truncation, and encryption. Examples of operations that decrease the security level include detokenization and decryption.

(21) The API service adapter **120** may perform security operations on specific fields of the API response data **152**. The API service adapter **120** may be configured to recognize those specific fields of the API response data **152**, and apply one or more security operations specified for those fields. For example, the API service adapter may be configured to evaluate each field included in the API response data **152** to determine whether the field satisfies a condition (e.g., having a certain identifier, such as a field name). When a field in the response data **152** satisfies the condition, the API service adapter may perform an associated data security operation (or plurality of data security operations) on the content stored in that field. The specified condition and the specified security operation may be associated with each other by a configuration of the API service adapter **120**. For example, the configuration may specify a condition of a field having the name “ssn” and associate this condition with performing a tokenization operation on any field satisfying the condition. The configuration of the API service adapter **120** is discussed in more detail below.

(22) The API service adapter **120** also may apply one or more data security operations on the API call **142**, and may do so on a field-by-field basis. That is, the API service adapter **120** may be configured to identify certain fields in the API call **142** that satisfy a specified condition (e.g., having a certain identifier, such as a field name), and apply an associated data security operation to those identified fields. The data security operation may be of any of the types mentioned earlier, including data security operations that increase or decrease the security level of data.

(23) Therefore, the API service adapter **120** is configured to modify (e.g., rewrite) inbound and/or outbound payloads at the endpoints of API **130**. In doing so, the API service adapter **120** may, for example, replace any raw sensitive information with encrypted values, values tokenized using an external tokenization service, masked values, or remove the values entirely.

(24) FIG. 1B illustrates an example of part of the data flow depicted in FIG. 1A. FIG. 1B particularly illustrates an example of the API service adapter **120** performing a data security operation to modify the payload of API response data **152A**, in order to generate modified API response data **154A** that is sent to the client **110**. API response data **152A** and **154A** in FIG. 1B are examples of API response data **152** and **154** of FIG. 1A, respectively.

(25) As shown in FIG. 1B, the API response data **152A** that is received by the API service adapter **120** includes a plurality of fields (“pan”, “ssn”, and “acct”) respectively storing a primary account number, a social security number, and an account ID number in unencrypted, plaintext format. The primary account number, social security number, and account ID number, may be sensitive information that is provided as part of the API service offered by the server **132**. In the instant example, the “pan”, “ssn”, and “account” fields, and their respective content, are included in the API response data **152A** as respective key-value pairs of a JSON object. That is, a JSON object key (e.g., “ssn”) is an example of a field, and the value of the key (e.g., “222334444” is a value) is an

example of data or content stored in the field.

(26) As shown in FIG. 1B, the API service adapter **120** filters the API response data **152A** so as to replace the values of the fields with secured values. In the instant example, a tokenization operation is performed in which the numbers stored in the “ssn” and “account” fields are replaced by tokens, and a field masking operation is performed in which the part of the number stored in the “pan” field are masked by placeholder characters. The modified API response data **154A** is then transmitted to the client **110**. In addition to modifying the data stored in the fields, the API service adapter may modify the names of the fields. As shown in FIG. 1B, in the modified API response data **154A**, the field name “pan” has been changed to “panSurrogate.”

(27) In general, API service adapter **120** may accept inputs and generate outputs in a variety of different formats, and may switch format between input and output. For example, the API response data **152A** received by the API service adapter **120** may be in an XML format, in which case the fields recognized by the API service adapter **120** may be denoted by the XML element name. The API service adapter **120** may be configured to recognize fields based on other criteria. For example, in the case of XML data, an attribute of an XML element name may be recognized as a field. Additionally, a field may be included as data of another field, and the content of a field may include multiple sub-fields.

(28) Referring back to FIG. 1A, the gateway or proxy implementing the API service adapter **120** may be a computer system or part of another computer system. In particular, the API service adapter **120** may, for example, be a Docker-based application that is configured, managed, and deployed within an approved scanning vendor (ASV) for which the API service adapter **120** produces services. Multiple instances of the API service adapter **120** may be deployed in a decentralized manner.

(29) In some implementations, the API service adapter **120** and the server **132** may be part of a first computer system, and the client **110** may be part of a second computer system. In such implementations, communication between the client **110** and the API service adapter **120** may pass through a public network such as the internet, in which case the proxy implementing the API service adapter **120** may be referred to as a reverse proxy. In other implementations, the API service adapter **120** and the client **110** may be part of a first computer system, and the server **132** may be part of a second computer system. In such implementations, communication between the server **132** and the API service adapter **120** may pass through a public network such as the internet, in which case the proxy implementing the API service adapter **120** may be referred to as a forward proxy. In other implementations, the client **110**, the API service adapter **120**, and the server **132** may all be part of the same computer system or private network. In other implementations, the client **110**, the API service adapter **120**, and the server **132** may each be on a separate respective computer system or network.

(30) Additionally, the client **110** and server **132** may switch roles while still utilizing the API service adapter **120** as an intermediary. For example, the server **132** may send an API call to the client **110** to request information from the client; this API call from the server **132** and/or the response from the client **110** may be modified by the API service adapter **12**. The client **110** or the server **132** also may have different roles in other client-server relationships. For example, the server **132** may have the role of a client in interacting with another server (e.g., a backend server) through the API service adapter **120** or through another implementation of the API service adapter **120**.

(31) The API service adapter **120** may operate based on a specified configuration stored in the computer system implementing the API service adapter **120**. The configuration may specify one or a plurality of services, each service specifying a set of operations of the API service adapter **120**. For each service, the configuration may define the following attributes of the service: (1) the URI (e.g., URL) pattern that the service is invoked on, which may be a URI pattern to which the API service adapter **120** listens; (2) the URI (e.g., URL) of the API **130** to which requests are sent; (3) the type or format of the payload (e.g., XML or JSON); (4) authentication mechanisms of the API

130 (e.g., oAuth, client-TLS); and (5) one or more attributes defining the modification of payloads at the endpoints of API **130**. Other attributes that may be defined include parameters pertaining to services used to perform the data security operation, such as a URI of a token service.

(32) The configuration of the API service adapter **120** may, for example, be specified in XML or JSON format, and may be a text file stored in a memory (volatile or non-volatile) of the computer system implementing the API service adapter **120**. In the example of a configuration file in JSON format, the parameters discussed above may be specified as a key-value pair, where the key indicates the name of the parameter and the value indicates the value of the parameter.

(33) The filters specified for a service may include one or more request filters, which modify API calls that are input into API **130** (e.g., the API call **142**), and/or one or more response filters, which modify outputs from API **130** (e.g., the API response data **152**). Each filter may, for example, include a definition of an inbound field name, a data security operation, and an outbound field name.

(34) The inbound field name may define the name of a data field of the inbound data. The inbound data may be the API call **142** for a request filter or the API response data **152** for a response filter. The outbound field defines a name of the data field to which the inbound field of the inbound data is modified. For example, in the example illustrated in FIG. **1B**, the inbound field for one output filter may be specified “pan” and the outbound field may be specified as “panSurrogate.”

(35) Thus, when the API service adapter **120** is being executed by one or more processors of the computer system implementing the API service adapter, the one or more processors may check the inbound data to determine whether it contains a field matching an inbound field name defined by any of the filters specified by the configuration file. The one or more processors may, for example, traverse through the entire set of fields in the inbound data to determine whether any of the fields has a field name specified in the configuration file. If there is such a field, then the one or more processors may apply the data security operation to content stored in the field, and rename the field according to the specified outbound field.

(36) The data security operation may, for example, be a tokenization operation, a detokenization operation, a field masking operation, a field redaction operation (e.g., removal of the entire field or the entire content within the field), a truncation operation, an encryption operation, or a decryption operation. Other possible data security operations include the conversion of a virtual token number into a token reference ID and vice versa.

(37) Specific settings or parameters of the data security operation may be specified in the filter type parameter, and/or other fields of the filter. The data security operation may be specified by one or more parameters of the filter. Additionally, the configuration may specify a plurality of data security operations to be applied to contents of a field.

(38) A tokenization operation may include replacing information with a token representing the information, and storing a mapping of the data between the data and the token with a token service. A detokenization operation may include replacing a token with the information represented by the token. The configuration may specify various settings of the tokenization or detokenization operation, such as the URI of a token service, and the particular type of tokenization or detokenization.

(39) For truncation and field masking, the configuration may specify the extent of truncation or a specific portion of field data (e.g., a range of indices of characters in a string) to be masked. For example, the filter may have a first parameter specifying the general type of operation (e.g., truncation and masking belonging to one type of operation) and a second parameter specifying the details of the operation. For example, the second parameter may be “TRUNC-FIRST6” to specify a truncation of the inbound field to the first 6 characters, or “MASK-6-X-4” to specify a masking of the first 6 up to (but not including) last 4 characters with the character “X.” The masking character(s) also may be random.

(40) Encryption and decryption operation may include encrypting or decrypting data by any

suitable manner of encryption or decryption, respectively. For example, the API service adapter **120** may provide field-level RSA encryption for encrypting sensitive data during transmission so as to provide an additional layer of security on top of TLS when transmitting data over an open network like the internet. For example, field-level RSA encryption may be used with tokenization to convert from an encrypted PAN to a Turing token.

(41) In order to implement encryption and decryption operations, the API service adapter **120** also may be capable of encryption key exchange. The API service adapter **120** may, for example, have a “handshake” mechanism for dynamically exchanging public keys over an open network as an alternative to static exchange mechanisms like emailing certificates.

(42) For example, to perform RSA encryption on sensitive information received from client **110**, the API service adapter **120** may receive a request from the client **110** requesting a current RSA public key. The API service adapter **120** may return the public key (encrypted or non-encrypted) and a key name to the client **110**. The key name may be included in the API call **142** and, based on the key name, the API service adapter **120** may encrypt various data fields of the API call **142**.

(43) In order for the API service adapter **120** to perform RSA encryption on sensitive information included in API response data **152**, the API service adapter **120** may use the RSA public key in the above scenario. The API service adapter **120** may instead request a public key from the client **110**. For example, the client **110** may access or generate an RSA keypair, and include the public key (encrypted or non-encrypted) in the API call **142**. The API service adapter **120** may then encrypt various data fields of the API response data **152** with the public key. The encrypted data, sent in the modified API response data **154**, may then be decrypted by the client **110** using its private key.

(44) FIGS. 2A and 2B illustrate two respective topologies for the client-server environment of FIG. 1A.

(45) FIG. 2A illustrates a first exemplary topology. In this topology, the API service adapter **120** and the API **130** are part of a restricted network **201**, while the client **110** is part of an external network **203**. Restricted network **201** and external network **203** also may be respectively referred to as a restricted computer system and an external computer system.

(46) In the example of payment card industry (PCI) networks, the topology of FIG. 2A may be utilized where a non-PCI client is consuming a PCI service. For example, the restricted network **201** may be a cardholder data environment (CDE) comprising a first portion **201A** and a second portion **201B**. The first portion **201A** may comprise “Category 1” system components, including system components that process, store, or transmit cardholder data. The second portion **201B** may comprise “Category 2” system components, including system components that have controlled access to “Category 1” system components. In the CDE context, the components of external network **203** may be classified as “Category 3” system components, which are isolated from “Category 1” system components.

(47) As shown in FIG. 2A, the client **110** and the API service adapter **120** may be in communication with one another through external gateway **215**, while the API **130** and the API service adapter **120** may be in communication with one another through internal gateway **225**. Additionally, a connection **240A** between the external gateway **215** and the client **110** (and other components of the external network **203**) may be through a public network such as the internet **260**, while the connections **240B**, **250A**, and **250B** may be connections within the restricted network **201**. External gateway **215** and internal gateway **225** may, for example, be API gateways implemented by Apigee or Amazon API Gateway.

(48) In the topology of FIG. 2A, messages sent between the client **110** and the API service adapter **120** may include data representing certain information (e.g., PAN) in a first type of security format, while messages sent between the API service adapter **120** and the API **130** may include data representing the same information in a second type of security format. For example, unencrypted plaintext may be one type of security format, while a token representation may be another type of security format. Therefore, the API service adapter **120** may serve the role of converting the

information (e.g., PAN) between one security format and another security format.

(49) As shown in FIG. 2A, the API service adapter **120** may have access to a token service **222** for purposes of performing tokenization or detokenization. The token service **222** may, for example, store or otherwise have access to a mapping between tokens and PANs, and provide the corresponding PAN to the API service adapter **120** in response to receiving a token from the API service adapter **120**. The token service **222** may, for example, be a token server having a database storing the aforementioned information.

(50) An example to illustrate the topology shown in FIG. 2A and the interaction between its components is provided as follows. In this example, the API **130** is as an API that inputs and outputs PANs only in the form of unencrypted plaintext, while the client **110** is a client that requires PANs to be tokenized for purposes of communicating with the restricted network **201**. With the benefit of the API service adapter **120**, the client **110** may send, to the API service adapter **120**, an API call **142** that includes a tokenized PAN as an input parameter (e.g., as a content of a data field of the API call **142**). The API service adapter **120** may convert the token into a PAN. To make this conversion, the API service adapter **120** may utilize token service **222**. The token service **222** provide the corresponding PAN to the API service adapter **120** in response to receiving a token from the API service adapter. The API service adapter **120** then modifies the API call **142** into a modified API call **144** by converting the token in the API call **142** to a PAN, and sends the PAN to the API **130**. The API **130** then returns API response data **152** to the API service adapter **120**, which then modifies the API response data **152** into modified API response data **154** by converting the PAN into a token (by, for example, using the token service **222**), before sending the modified API response data **154** to the client **110**.

(51) Accordingly, as illustrated by the above example, the deployment model of FIG. 2A allows the calling of a service provided by the API **130** that exposes PAN from a client **110** of another network. The client **110** thus consumes the rewritten (tokenized) service passed through the external gateway **215**, and the API service adapter **120** thus consumes the PAN-exposing service passed through the internal gateway **225**.

(52) Another example to illustrate the topology shown in FIG. 2A and the interaction between its components is provided as follows. In this second example, the server **132** operates an API **130** that returns the balance and recent transactions of a credit card. In order to reduce the amount of sensitive information inside the restricted network **201**, the API **130** in this example requires a token representation of a PAN in order to process the query requesting the balance and recent transactions. Additionally, the token is internal to the restricted network **201**.

(53) Therefore, in order for a client **110** of the external network **203** to query for the balance and recent transactions of a credit card, the API service adapter **120** may convert the PAN (e.g., 4400000000001111) of an incoming API call **142** from the client **110** to a corresponding token (e.g., 440000abcdef1111). The API service adapter **120** calls the API **130** using the token as a modified API call **144**. The API service adapter **120** then retrieves, from the API **130**, an API response data **152** including the balance and recent transactions of the credit card, and the token corresponding to the PAN. Since the token is internal to the restricted network **201**, the API service adapter **120** converts the token back to the PAN, and sends modified API response data **1** including the PAN together with the balance and recent transactions of the credit card.

(54) FIG. 2B illustrates a second exemplary topology. FIG. 2B differs from FIG. 2A in that the client **110** and the API **130** have switched places, relative to their positions in FIG. 2A. That is, in FIG. 2B, client **110** is now part of the restricted network **201**, while the API **130** is part of the external network **203**. Any of the features of the restricted network **201**, the external network **203**, and other components discussed above for FIG. 2A, also may apply to like components (e.g., components having the same reference character denotation) in FIG. 2B. For example, the connection **240A** in FIG. 2B may be through a public network, such as the internet **260**, while the other connections (e.g., **240B**, **250A**, and **250B**) may be through the restricted network **201**.

(55) In the example of payment card industry (PCI) networks, the topology of FIG. 2B may be utilized where a PCI client is consuming a non-PCI service. As an example to illustrate the topology of FIG. 2B, the client **110** in FIG. 2B may be a client that inputs and outputs PANs only in unencrypted plaintext format. The client **110** may request data from the API **130**, but the API **130** in this example requires an input of PAN in tokenized form in order to provide the data desired by the client **110**, and additionally outputs PAN in tokenized form together with the desired data. Therefore, with the benefit of the API service adapter **120**, the client **110** may send an API call **142** (containing PAN in unencrypted plaintext format) to have it processed by the API service adapter **120** into a modified API call **144** (in which the PAN is tokenized). The API service adapter **120** then sends the modified API call **144** to the API **130**, which returns an API response data **152** including a tokenized PAN. The API service adapter **120** detokenizes the PAN, and sends the modified API response data **154** to the client **110**.

(56) FIG. 3 illustrates an example process for adapting an API by rewriting an output of the API, according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The process may be performed by one or more processors of a computer system implementing the API service adapter **120** shown in FIG. 1A. The process of FIG. 3 includes the following: receiving, from a client computer system, an API call for requesting information from a server (step **301**); calling an API of the server to request the information (step **302**); and receiving, from the server, API response data including a data field storing data indicating the information (step **303**). The data that is stored in the data field of step **303** may be data indicating the information (which may be sensitive information) that was requested by the API call in step **301** or some other information (which may be sensitive information) that is returned in the API response data. Data indicating a certain information may depict that information in unencrypted plaintext format, or in a processed (e.g., encrypted or tokenized) format.

(57) The process illustrated in FIG. 3 further includes: determining that the data field of the API response data satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation (step **304**). The condition in this step may be having a field name specified in configuration data stored in a memory of a computer system. The process illustrated in FIG. 3 further includes: modifying the API response data by performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field (step **305**); and sending, to the client computer system, the modified API response data (step **306**).

(58) An example to illustrate the process shown in FIG. 3 is presented as follows, with reference to components shown in FIG. 1. In this example, the server **132** is operating an API **130** that receives an input of an account number (e.g., 11321234432423) and returns a list of PANs (e.g., credit card numbers) associated with that account number (e.g., PANs belonging to an account identified by the account number). Additionally, in this example, the API **130** returns all digits of PANs in unencrypted plaintext format, but the client **110** (client computer system) only needs the last four digits of the PAN.

(59) The client **110** sends an API call **142** to a URL associated with the API service adapter **120**. The API call **142** may include the account number in a data field of the API call **142**, as well as information indicating that it is a request for a list of PANs. A reverse proxy server implementing the API service adapter **120** may be listening to the URL. While listening to this URL, the reverse proxy server intercepts the API call **142**, so as to receive the API call (in accordance with step **301** of FIG. 3).

(60) In calling the API **130** to request the PANs (in accordance with step **302** of FIG. 1), the reverse proxy server may generate a new API call **144** containing the address of the server **132**, which may be an address that is inaccessible by the client **110**. Depending on the specifics of the implementation, the payload of the new API call **144** may be the same or modified from the payload of API call **142**. In some implementations, the reverse proxy server also may alter the format of the API call **142**, and/or any of its fields and their payloads.

(61) After sending the API call **144** to the server **132**, the reverse proxy server receives API

response data **152** including a data field storing the two PANs associated with the account number (in accordance with step **303** of FIG. 3). For example, the API response data **152** may include a JSON object as follows: {"pan": ["4400000000001111", "4400000000001112"], "acct": "11321234432423"}. That is, in the above example, the API response data **152** includes a field named "pan" storing the two PANs as an array of two numbers.

(62) In accordance with step **304** of FIG. 3, the reverse proxy server may determine that the field name "pan" matches a list of field names stored in configuration data in association with a security operation to be performed on content stored in any field having the field name "pan." The configuration data specifies that the security operation to be performed is a field masking operation, in which all characters other than the last four characters are to be masked (e.g., hidden). Therefore, in accordance with step **305** of FIG. 3, the reverse proxy server modifies the API response data **152** by changing the value of the key-value pair to: ["*****1111", "*****1112"]. The configuration data also may specify that the field name "pan" be changed to "maskedpan," and the field name may be changed accordingly.

(63) Then, in accordance with step **306** of FIG. 3, the modified API response data **154** is sent to the client computer system (client **110**). In this example, the modified API response data **154** includes the following JSON object in place of the above JSON object: {"maskedpan": ["*****1111", "*****1112"], "acct": "11321234432423"}.

(64) According to the above example, API service adapter **120** adapts the output of the API **130** so as to avoid an unnecessary exposure of the full PANs when the client **110** does not need the full PANs.

(65) FIG. 4 illustrates an example process for adapting an API by rewriting an input of the API, according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure. The process may be performed by one or more processors of a computer system implementing the API service adapter **120**. The process includes: receiving, from a client computer system, an API call requesting information from a server (step **401**); determining that a data field of the API call satisfies a condition for applying a data security operation to data stored in the data field (step **402**); performing the data security operation on the data stored in the data field of the API call to obtain processed data (step **403**); based on the API call, generating a second API call for requesting the information stored on the server, the second API call including the processed data (step **404**); sending the second API call to the server (step **405**); retrieving, from the server, API response data generated by the server in response to the second API call (step **406**); and sending, to the client computer system, the API response data or a modification of the API response data (step **407**).

(66) FIG. 5 illustrates an example process in which decryption is performed on information received from a client computer system. The process illustrated in FIG. 5 may be considered to be an example implementation of the general process shown in FIG. 4. As shown in FIG. 5, the client **110** sends a key request (**501**) to the API service adapter **120**. Client **110** may be any system that performs the interactions shown in FIG. 5. For example, in a payment card industry application, client **110** may be an interactive voice response (IVR) system, such as an IVR system that provides a credit card activation service allowing customers to activate a credit card by telephone. In response to receiving key request **501**, the API service adapter **120** generates a private key, a public key **503**, and a key name **502** used to identify the private key. The API service adapter **120** stores the private key and the key name **502** in a data storage or memory of the computer system implementing the API service adapter **120**, and sends the key name **502** and public key **503** to the client **110**. The client then uses the public key to encrypt a PAN. Using the encrypted PAN, the client **110** sends an API call **511** that includes the encrypted PAN in a certain field identifiable by the API service adapter **120**, as well as the key name **502**. The API call **511** is received by the API service adapter **120**, in accordance with step **501** of FIG. 4. The API call **511** of FIG. 6, including an encrypted PAN and the key name **502**, is an example of API call **142** of FIG. 1.

(67) After receiving the API call **511**, the API service adapter **120** determines that the field storing

the encrypted PAN satisfies a condition for applying a decryption operation to data stored in the field, in accordance with step **402** of FIG. **4**. The API service adapter **120** then decrypts the encrypted PAN by selecting the private key using the key name, and using the private key (step **520** of FIG. **6**; step **403** of FIG. **5**). Optionally, the API service adapter **120** performs tokenization of the decrypted PAN (step **530** of FIG. **6**), if the API service adapter **120** has been configured to do so. The process of FIG. **6** then proceeds with the API service adapter sending an API call **531** to the API **130** using the decrypted (and optionally tokenized) PAN, and receiving an API response data **532** from the API **130** of the server **132**, in accordance with the remaining steps of FIG. **4**.

(68) According to the methods and systems of this disclosure, an existing API may be adapted by using an API service adapter **120** that rewrites the input and outputs of the existing API **130**.

Therefore, the API service adapter **120** provides a “bolt-on” adapter that can adapt the existing API **130** to various security formats and security requirements for the input and output of the API **130**.

(69) Implementation of the API service adapter **120** allows existing assets to be leveraged against new security or compliance requirements, so as to avoid the need to rewrite the existing API and to avoid disruption to clients that are already using the existing API. Furthermore, implementation of the API service adapter **120** externalizes some of the more sensitive security considerations from business applications in a way that encourages consistency, shields technology assets from ongoing remediation requirements, and provides a turn-key solution for increasing the security of an existing API **130**.

(70) In general, any process discussed in this disclosure that is understood to be performable by a computer may be performed by one or more processors. Such processes include, but are not limited to: the processes shown in FIGS. **3-5**; and processes involving operations of the client **110**, the API service adapter **120**, the API **130**, and the server **132**. The one or more processors may be configured to perform such processes by having access to instructions (computer-readable code) that, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform the processes. The one or more processors may be part of a computer system (e.g., one of the computer systems discussed above) that further includes a memory storing the instructions. The instructions also may be stored on a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The non-transitory computer-readable medium may be separate from any processor. Examples of non-transitory computer-readable media include solid-state memories, optical media, and magnetic media.

(71) It should be appreciated that in the above description of exemplary embodiments of the invention, various features of the invention are sometimes grouped together in a single embodiment, figure, or description thereof for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure and aiding in the understanding of one or more of the various inventive aspects. This method of disclosure, however, is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed invention requires more features than are expressly recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive aspects lie in less than all features of a single foregoing disclosed embodiment. Thus, the claims following the Detailed Description are hereby expressly incorporated into this Detailed Description, with each claim standing on its own as a separate embodiment of this invention.

(72) Furthermore, while some embodiments described herein include some but not other features included in other embodiments, combinations of features of different embodiments are meant to be within the scope of the invention, and form different embodiments, as would be understood by those skilled in the art. For example, in the following claims, any of the claimed embodiments can be used in any combination.

(73) Thus, while certain embodiments have been described, those skilled in the art will recognize that other and further modifications may be made thereto without departing from the spirit of the invention, and it is intended to claim all such changes and modifications as falling within the scope of the invention. For example, functionality may be added or deleted from the block diagrams and operations may be interchanged among functional blocks. Steps may be added or deleted to methods described within the scope of the present invention.

(74) The above disclosed subject matter is to be considered illustrative, and not restrictive, and the appended claims are intended to cover all such modifications, enhancements, and other implementations, which fall within the true spirit and scope of the present disclosure. Thus, to the maximum extent allowed by law, the scope of the present disclosure is to be determined by the broadest permissible interpretation of the following claims and their equivalents, and shall not be restricted or limited by the foregoing detailed description. While various implementations of the disclosure have been described, it will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art that many more implementations and implementations are possible within the scope of the disclosure. Accordingly, the disclosure is not to be restricted except in light of the attached claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method comprising: receiving first formatted data of a first format type from an adapter configured as an intermediary between a first computing system and a second computing system, wherein the second computing system is associated with an application programming interface (API), and the first formatted data is received by the adapter as one of input to the API or output from the API; utilizing a mapping between data of the first format type and corresponding data of a second format type to identify second formatted data of the second format type corresponding to the first formatted data; and providing the second formatted data to the adapter, wherein the adapter modifies, by replacing the first formatted data with the second formatted data, the one of the input to the API to provide to the second computing system or the output from the API to provide to the first computing system.
2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein utilizing the mapping to identify the second formatted data of the second format type corresponding to the first formatted data comprises: performing one or more data security operations, including at least one of a tokenization operation or a detokenization operation.
3. The computer-implemented method of claim 2, wherein one of the first formatted data or the second formatted data includes raw data, and an other of the first formatted data or the second formatted data is a token representing the raw data.
4. The computer-implemented method of claim 3, wherein the raw data is in unencrypted, plaintext format.
5. The computer-implemented method of claim 3, wherein the raw data includes an account number or a personal identifier.
6. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein: when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the input to the API, the second format type complies with a format requirement of the second computing system, and when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the output from the API, the second format type complies with a format requirement of the first computing system.
7. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein replacing the first formatted data with the second formatted data adjusts a security level associated with the one of the input to the API or the output from the API modified by the adapter.
8. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the input to the API: the first formatted data is received as an input parameter of an API call including a request for information stored on the second computing system, and a modified API call, including the input to the API modified by the adapter, is provided to the second computing system through the API.
9. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the output from the API: the first formatted data is received by the adapter as part of an API response including information stored on the second computing system that was

requested by the first computing system, and a modified API response, including the output from the API modified by the adapter, is provided to the first computing system.

10. A system comprising: a memory storing instructions; and one or more processors configured to execute the instructions to perform operations including: receiving first formatted data of a first format type from an adapter configured as an intermediary between a first computing system and a second computing system, wherein the second computing system is associated with an application programming interface (API), and the first formatted data is received by the adapter as one of input to the API or output from the API; utilizing a mapping between data of the first format type and corresponding data of a second format type to identify second formatted data of the second format type corresponding to the first formatted data; and providing the second formatted data to the adapter, wherein the adapter modifies, by replacing the first formatted data with the second formatted data, the one of the input to the API to provide to the second computing system or the output from the API to provide to the first computing system.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the system is associated with a token service, and utilizing the mapping to identify the second formatted data of the second format type corresponding to the first formatted data comprises: performing one or more data security operations, including at least one of a tokenization operation or a detokenization operation.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein one of the first formatted data or the second formatted data includes raw data, and an other of the first formatted data or the second formatted data is a token representing the raw data.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the raw data is sensitive information including an account number or a personal identifier.

14. The system of claim 10, wherein the system further includes a data store configured to store the mapping, and utilizing the mapping comprises retrieving the mapping from the data store.

15. The system of claim 10, wherein: when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the input to the API, the second format type complies with a format requirement of the second computing system, and when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the output from the API, the second format type complies with a format requirement of the first computing system.

16. The system of claim 10, wherein replacing the first formatted data with the second formatted data adjusts a security level associated with the one of the input to the API or the output from the API modified by the adapter.

17. The system of claim 10, wherein the API and at least one of the first computing system or the second computing system is part of a restricted network.

18. The system of claim 10, wherein when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the input to the API: the first formatted data is received as an input parameter of an API call including a request for information stored on the second computing system, and a modified API call, including the input to the API modified by the adapter, is provided to the second computing system through the API.

19. The system of claim 10, wherein when the first formatted data is received by the adapter as the output from the API: the first formatted data is received by the adapter as part of an API response including information stored on the second computing system that was requested by the first computing system, and a modified API response, including the output from the API modified by the adapter, is provided to the first computing system.

20. A computer-implemented method comprising: receiving first formatted data of a first format type from an adapter configured as an intermediary between a first computing system and a second computing system, wherein the second computing system is associated with an application programming interface (API), and the first formatted data is received by the adapter as one of input to the API or output from the API; performing a data security operation using a mapping between data of the first format type and corresponding data of a second format type to identify second formatted data of the second format type corresponding to the first formatted data, wherein one of

the first formatted data or the second formatted data includes raw data values, and an other of the first formatted data or the second formatted data includes secured values representing the raw data values; and providing the second formatted data to the adapter, wherein the adapter rewrites, by replacing the first formatted data with the second formatted data, the one of the input to the API to provide to the second computing system or the output from the API to provide to the first computing system.
